

PostgreSQL Password Reset & Django Connection Fix (Windows)

Problem:

While running 'python manage.py migrate', the following error occurred:
django.db.utils.OperationalError:
FATAL: password authentication failed for user "postgres"

Cause:

Incorrect PostgreSQL password configured in Django settings.

Solution Steps:

1. Confirm PostgreSQL Port

- Open: C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\18\data\postgresql.conf
- Search for: port =
- Confirm server running on port 5433

2. Verify Connection Manually

Run:

& "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\18\bin\psql.exe" -U postgres -p 5433

Result: Password authentication failed

3. Stop PostgreSQL Service

- Open Run → services.msc
- Stop: postgresql-x64-18

4. Modify Authentication Method

- Open: C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\18\data\pg_hba.conf
- Change 'scram-sha-256' to 'trust' for:
host all all 127.0.0.1/32 trust
host all all ::1/128 trust

5. Restart PostgreSQL Service

6. Login Without Password

Run:

& "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\18\bin\psql.exe" -U postgres -p 5433

7. Reset Password

Inside psql:

ALTER USER postgres WITH PASSWORD 'NewPassword';

Then exit using:

\q

8. Restore Secure Authentication

- Change 'trust' back to 'scram-sha-256' in pg_hba.conf
- Restart PostgreSQL service

9. Update Django settings.py

Ensure:

PASSWORD = 'NewPassword'

PORT = '5433'

10. Run Migration

```
python manage.py migrate
```

Final Result:

- PostgreSQL password reset successfully
- Django connected properly
- Migrations executed without errors